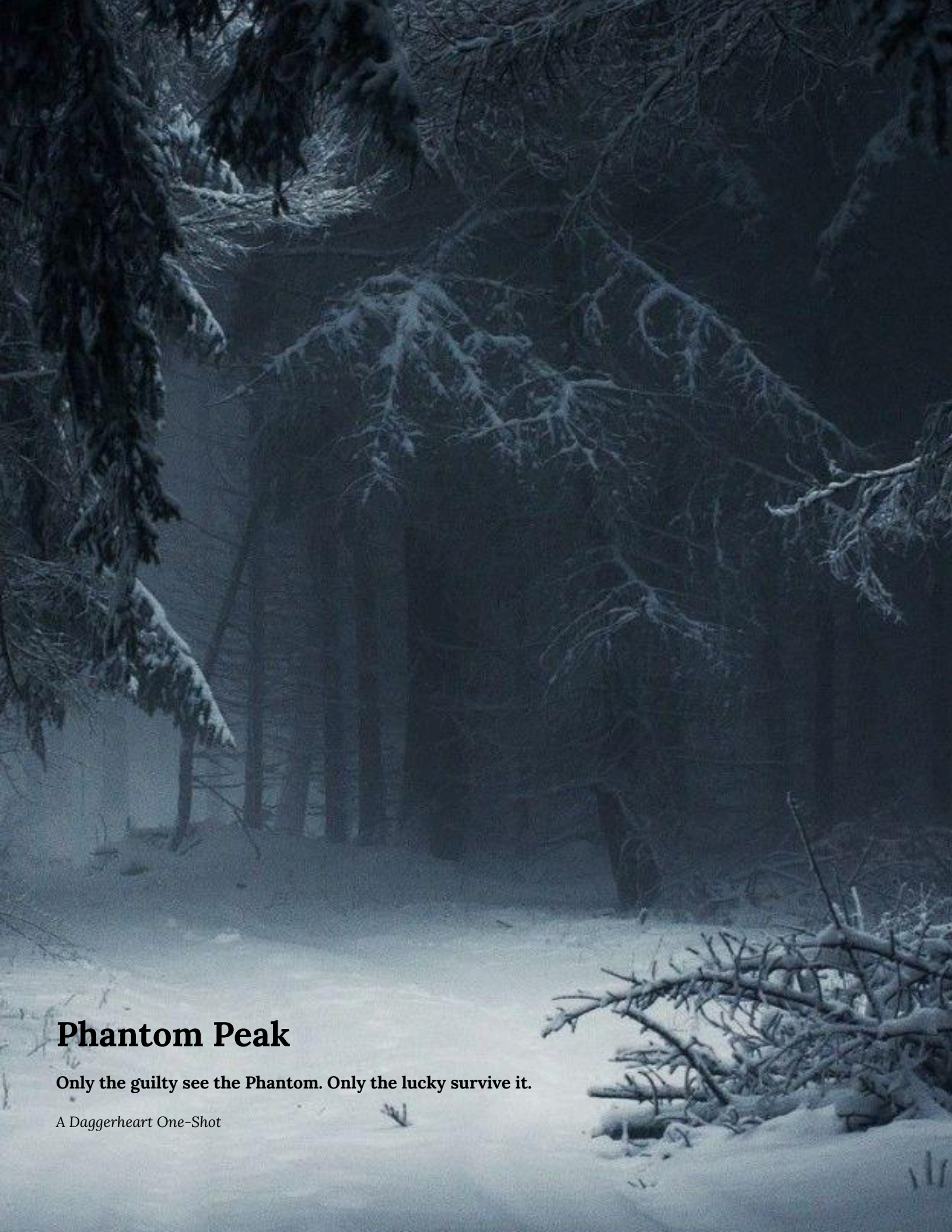


Phantom Peak

Only the guilty see the Phantom. Only the lucky survive it.

A *Daggerheart One-Shot*

Overview

Phantom Peak is a psychological horror adventure designed for a party of 3-5 level 1 characters using the Daggerheart system.

This document has been laid out to make running the adventure easier for the GM. Important information or characters are highlighted in **bold**.

Give your players the following synopsis to introduce them to the adventure.

"You've arrived at a remote winter lodge for a much-needed escape, high in the mountains above the quiet mining town of Phantom Peak. But as night falls, strange things begin to stir in the snow.

Something is stalking you. It knows what you've done.

Only the guilty see the Phantom.
Only the lucky survive it."

Character Creation

When your players are creating their characters for this adventure, ask them to include one other NPC that their character **feels guilt over**. This could be a scored ex-lover, or someone they killed. This guilt will be used by the Phantom to torment the characters during the adventure.

History

Phantom Peak Co. was once a sprawling and wide-reaching company, with many divisions including a fishing company, a mining company, and a holiday park, among others. However, after a **mining accident twenty years ago**, the company's reputation nosedived, and now Phantom Peak Holiday Park is all that remains of their legacy.

Phantom Peak Holiday Park is based in the Phantom Peak Mountains, and was the company's first division - **now their last**. It is said that Phantom Peak Co. chose Phantom Peak as their base of operations and namesake due to it being the only known place to mine **jadeite**, a rare and expensive green gem. Though Phantom Peak's popularity has decreased in recent years after the mines closed down, the Holiday Park still sees some visitors.

Twenty years ago, **six miners** of Phantom Peak Mining Company descended into the mines, but **only one returned.** Four were **found dead** in a mineshaft. The surviving miner, Martha, spoke about a monster which she called **the Phantom**, which took different forms to each miner. Most dismissed her tale as madness, but then the stories started. Over time, the lie became real - whether through fear, belief, or something much older that was waiting in the dark. The Phantom took shape: a cryptid of shared trauma, an urban legend that **punishes the guilty**.

The truth behind the incident is much darker. **Felix** was the foreman on the day of the accident, and discovered a vein of jadeite. He was under pressure to deliver results, and **ordered that the jadeite be extracted**. Only pickaxes wouldn't do it - it had to be **something stronger.** The other miners protested, telling Felix that this wasn't worth risking their lives, but Felix didn't listen. He used dynamite to successfully extract the jadeite, but in doing so **caused a cave-in** - and instead of trying to save the other miners trapped in the tunnel, **Felix ran, saving himself**. He was unaware that Martha had also survived, and **faked his own death**, later committing suicide to **avoid the consequences for what he did**.

The Phantom

During the adventure, the party are stalked by cryptid creatures known as Phantoms, **shape-changing entities** that **feed on guilt and regret**. The Phantom takes the form of something the player characters **feel regret or guilt over**, such as a scorned ex-lover or a lost friend. The Phantom feeds on the guilt and regret of its victims, before killing and eating them, growing in strength and gaining the ability to use their form permanently.

Running the Phantom

The Phantom is the main antagonist of the one-shot and should be the **primary adversary**. The GM should be on the lookout for opportunities where the Phantom's appearance would be **narratively satisfying or cause conflict**.

To help with determining when the Phantom should appear, the GM may use the following countdown as a guide:

Guilt Form Countdown

Set a countdown with **six segments**. When this countdown is full, the Phantom will make an appearance.

Add 1 segment to the countdown whenever a player makes a **significant action**. This can be an action where the player would need to roll their Duality Dice, or at the GM's discretion.

Add 2 segments to the countdown whenever a player makes a **loud noise** (such as starting a generator or firing a gun).

When the countdown is full, secretly assign all players a number and roll to determine which **Guilt Form** the Phantom will take. For example, if you are playing at a table with 4 players, assign each player a number 1 through 4 and then roll a d4 to determine the outcome.

After the Phantom has taken a Guilt Form, **reset the countdown**.

Guilt Form Example

As an example for making the most of the Phantom's Guilt Form ability, let us imagine that in your party is an Orc Warrior named Rekka. Her player decided that her guilt is that in the past, Rekka was forced to kill her best friend in the name of her King.

When running Phantom encounters for Rekka, the GM should consider her guilt and have the Phantom appear to her as the form of her **best friend** - either alive and well, or as a zombie version of the best friend's dead self.

The GM should always keep in mind that the Phantom's motivations are to lure player characters to somewhere remote, and play the Phantom's illusions accordingly.

THE PHANTOM

Tier 2 Solo

A shape-shifting demon which takes on the form of something its victims feel guilt over.

Motives & Tactics: Takes the form of anything its targets feel guilt or regret over in order to lure them somewhere remote.

Difficulty: 14 | **Thresholds:** 12 / 20 | **HP:** 6 | **Stress:** 3
ATK: +3 | **Claws:** Melee | **1d8** Physical

Experience: Instinct +3

FEATURES

Relentless – Passive: The Phantom can be spotlighted up to two times per turn. Spend Fear as usual to spotlight them.

Guilt-Ridden – Passive: The Phantom has the ability to perfectly mimic the form of someone that a player character feels guilt or regret over. When attacking a Guilt-Ridden PC, the standard attack deals **2d10 + 1** damage instead of its standard damage.

Guilt-Form – Action: Spend a Fear to transform into a Guilt Form of a target character. If the target character can see the Phantom, they must succeed on an Instinct Reaction Roll to determine the illusion as fake or become Guilt-Ridden. While Guilt-Ridden, a target is Vulnerable.

Feed on Guilt – Reaction: When the Phantom makes a successful attack against a Guilt-Ridden PC, you gain a Fear.

Spectral Form – Reaction: When the Phantom is affected by a loud ringing noise (such as a bell or alarm) or a bright flash of light (such as the flash from a digital camera), it becomes Vulnerable for a Phantom Countdown (4). During this time, the Phantom cannot take on its Guilt Forms or gain benefits from attacking Guilt-Ridden PCs.

Introduction

We meet the player characters as they are travelling up to the mountain of Phantom Peak in a **rickety cable car**.

Read the following paragraph to your players to set the scene:

"*We meet you in a rickety cable car travelling up the infamous Phantom Peak Mountain, the birthplace of Phantom Peak Co, where you have booked a holiday cabin for a week's break from the struggles of modern life. The sun has set and darkness is slowly setting in - the visibility is not helped by the snowstorm, which is falling hard and fast and shows no sign of stopping soon. The cable car is small, and jaunty music plays out of a hidden radio. A tinny voice announces that you will be arriving at your destination shortly.*"

Introduce the characters at this point and allow some time for in-character talking and roleplay. The characters arrive at the cable car station and depart, facing the **Phantom Peak Cabins**. The area is rundown and looks undermaintained, but still manages to appear cozy.

The rest of this document details the individual locations in Phantom Peak. The GM should allow the players to move naturally between the locations, giving guidance to new locations when necessary or narratively satisfying.

Reception

The players should first be guided to the reception, where they are asked to sign in and meet Poppy Posie, who will take them to their cabin. Here they can find a map of the park (see at the end of the document).

NPCS:

Poppy Posie (Fake) - Jovial young receptionist with frizzy red hair and is excited by the idea of the Phantom cryptid. (GM Note: This version of Poppy is actually a **Phantom in disguise** - the real Poppy died in the mining accident)

Elias Brandt (Fake) - Haunted and gruff janitor. He claims to be the only survivor of the mining incident, and has seen the Phantom face to face. (GM Note: This version of Elias is actually the **Phantom in disguise** - the real Elias died in the mining accident)

Points of Interest:

Logbook: There is a small logbook in the entryway for players to write their names and date of arrival. If questioned, Poppy states that this is for 'safety reasons'.

Pinboard: A few grainy polaroid pictures are poorly attached to it. They each have a barely discernable **humanoid silhouette** in the background. There's a **missing person poster** for a hiker, posted several weeks prior. There are also warnings about **avalanches**, and advice on what to do if you find yourself in a snowstorm.

Front Desk: Old guest logbook with odd entries (scratched out names, frantic notes). There's also a leaflet map of the park that players can take.

Staff Room: Kegs, canned food, broken crates stamped **Phantom Peak Mining Co**. Locked trunk with belongings from the mining incident years ago - old lanterns, pickaxes and three aged sepia photographs. Two photographs show happy miners working, while the third shows **two miners brutally murdered** and a person with a bloody hand in the foreground.

Key Rack: A brass key with a tag labelled 'Supply Shed' and a **silver key** which opens the locked trunk in the staff room.

Cable Car Station

NPCS:

None

Points of Interest:

Cable Car: A rusted cable car lies idle by the station. It **will not start** and the controls are iced over, despite having been operated not long ago.

Slashed Cables: The cables have been sabotaged, seemingly by something sharp, **preventing anyone from leaving the park**.

Broken Emergency Radio: Needs a little tinkering and power (from a portable battery or the supply shed), but could be used to radio for help.

Pine Lodge

Pine Lodge is the party's cabin. It appears **cozy and charming**, rustic but a little **outdated**.

NPCS:

None

Points of Interest:

Generator: Stored outside around the back of the cabin. The cabin's only source of electricity. Fixing it might draw attention (noise attracts the Phantom or nearby wolves).

Outhouse: Full of gaps and made of rotting wood. The only available 'bathroom'.

Living Room: A **half-burnt letter** in the fireplace from Elias Brandt to someone named "Martha." It apologizes for "letting it out."

Hidden Floorboard Compartment: Inside is an old photograph of the mining crew, yellowed with age. It names on the back the six miners involved in the accident - **Poppy, Elias, Martha, Kevin, James** and **Felix**.

Willow Lodge

Willow Lodge is a cabin adjacent to Pine Lodge, decorated as a **honeymoon** cabin.

NPCS:

Steve and Barbara - An older couple celebrating their 30 years anniversary. They come to the park every year around this time. **Secret:** They are **Poppy's** (one of the miners who died in the accident) aging mother and father. They come to the park every year **so they can see their daughter again**, even though they are well aware it is not really her.

Points of Interest:

Master Bedroom: Decorated for a honeymoon, with rose petals, wine bottles and champagne glasses. A ring engraved 'S+B' and covered in blood lies on the nightstand.

Wedding Album: Entries stop mid-sentence; later pages are scribbled over with "*She came back.*"

Cedar Lodge

Cedar Lodge is a cabin which appears to be unoccupied, but has **filming equipment set up** and it looks like someone was there recently.

NPCS:

Film Students - Three film students are hiding in the house - **David, Daphne and Susan**. They came to Phantom Peak to film a **found footage horror movie** for college, but have been seeing strange things around the park.

David - Pragmatic, but breaking down. Keeps filming "for evidence." Believes the Phantom is real. Won't leave without his camera.

Daphne - Defensive humor; scared to admit she saw something stalking them. Secretly deleted part of the footage because it showed her guilt. **Secret:** She **killed Susan** in the woods by accident. When she returned to the cabin, Susan was there, and alive - but different. Daphne doesn't know what exactly is happening, but she knows it isn't good.

Susan - Does not believe in the Phantom despite evidence. Very scientific and down to earth. Convinced that whatever is out there is a figment of their

imagination. **Secretly a Phantom** taking on Daphne's Guilt Form.

Points of Interest:

Living Room: The place smells faintly of burnt coffee and damp film reels. A **makeshift set** is arranged - tripods, camera lights, and props depicting cryptid symbols crudely painted in fake blood. One of the cameras contains film, recently recorded. In the background, **a vague humanoid shadow**.

Script Pages: Scattered across the floor. Some of the script pages have been rewritten hastily, talking about "it" watching.

Upstairs Bedroom: Daphne's room houses some more film equipment and her **laptop** (which has a broken screen). A file labelled 'I'M SORRY' can be found on the laptop. On playback, faint audio can be heard: crying, a single gunshot, and screaming - and Daphne whispering "*I'm sorry, Suze.*" If Daphne realizes players have seen this, she panics, insisting "it wasn't supposed to happen - it was an accident."

Oak Lodge

Oak Lodge is a cabin currently housing **a group of young men** at a bachelor party, most of whom are **blackout drunk**. Music blasts from portable speakers, and shattered bottles and broken glass litters the floor.

NPCS:

Max Winterfern - Unhappy with the place that his friends chose to have his **bachelor party** (a cheap, rundown holiday cabin). He heard a **hiker went missing** nearby after supposedly witnessing their ex wife calling them from a peak higher up the mountain. **Secret:** Max recently had a fight with his fiancee, **Laura**, which ended in her telling him that she 'needed space'.

Drunken Bachelors (x6) - A group of bachelors who are all blackout drunk.

Points of Interest:

Kitchen Counter: A note scribbled on a napkin: "*We saw it on the ridge. Don't tell Max. This will be the perfect prank!*"

Max's Backpack: Contains a ring box and a letter to his fiancée apologizing for something terrible he did - a guilt hook for him or players.

Unopened Gift Box: Labeled "To Max — from the boys." Inside is a taxidermied one-eyed magpie with a note: "*For good luck - it sees all.*"

Optional Encounter: One drunk bachelor (or Max) wanders off into the fog; later found dead, eyes wide open.

Birch Lodge

An abandoned cabin with rotting wood and broken furniture. It seems like a normal cabin at first glance, but upon closer inspection seems to have at one point been **someone's hideout**.

NPCS:

Felix Orner (Deceased) - The corpse of Felix Orner can be found slumped over a desk in the bedroom. It seems as though he **committed suicide**, and a **pistol** lies on the floor. His hand still clutches a bloodied photograph of him and **Martha**.

Points of Interest:

Bedroom: There is a note penned by Felix (one of the miners) which reads: "*The mine... it remembers what we did. It has sent it to seek vengeance, to punish us for our misdeeds. I have to stop it before it kills more - no matter the cost.*"

Phantom Research: A small bedroom at the back of the cabin has seemingly been converted into a research lab. There is a **detached arm** on the desk (which players may recognise as being the arm of a Phantom, if they have

experienced one's true form) bleeding **transparent blood**.

Phonograph: A cracked recorder with a tape inserted. The audio cuts in and out, with **Felix** talking. It reveals what really happened that night. Felix was the foreman, and discovered a vein of **jadeite**. He was under pressure to deliver results, and ordered that the jadeite be extracted. Only pickaxes wouldn't do it - it had to be **something stronger**. The other miners protested, telling Felix that this wasn't worth risking their lives, but **Felix didn't listen**. He used dynamite to successfully extract the jadeite, but in doing so **caused a cave-in** - and instead of trying to save the other miners trapped in the tunnel, **Felix ran, saving himself**. He was unaware that Martha had also survived, and **faked his own death** to avoid the consequences for what he did.

[Static. Heavy breathing.]
"This is… this is Felix Orner, foreman, Jadeite Operation, Phantom Peak."
"We found something… jadeite, just like they said we would. But there was something else there too… something old."
"I… I told them to keep digging. I told them we'd be rich. That this green stone was the company's future."
"The others told me they were seeing things, hearing things. They begged me to call it off, but still I insisted."
"Pickaxes couldn't break it. I thought dynamite would do it.
They told me no. They begged me not to. But I… I had orders. I had to give them results."
"It came down on them. All of them. I could've gone back. I could've done *something* - but I ran. God help me, I ran."
"They're still calling for me - in the tunnels. I hear their voices when I close my eyes."
"Martha… if you ever find this - I'm so sorry. I should have gone back for them. It was my fault, not yours. It was never your fault. I'm sorry I let you believe that all these years."
"I thought it would be trapped down there, but it wasn't. It followed me back up here. It wears their faces. It- I'm so sorry. This is all my fault."
[The tape ends.]

Burnt Letter: The other half of the burned letter that the party can find in Pine Lodge. "*[Referring to Martha]* I never meant for it to happen. I didn't know… I saw your name in the hospital records. I can't face you, not after what I did. I didn't mean for them *[referring to the miners]* to die."

Cabin Amenities

Situated centrally to the cabins is a small meeting area, with a campfire and hot tub.

NPCS:

None

Points of Interest:

Campfire: The campfire looks to have been recently lit. Hidden in the ashes is a piece of paper, seemingly a note from a man to his girlfriend begging for forgiveness and saying that he'll 'make it right'.

Hot Tub: A dirty and poorly maintained hot tub. The water flow is poor and also dirty.

Picnic Table: Someone carved "*It watches.*"

Abandoned Snow Mobile: Could be used to travel faster or perform a hasty escape, but it needs fuel (and the noise might attract the Phantom)

Bar

Adjacent to the reception, near the cabin campfire area is a small but well stocked bar.

NPCS:

Nessa Vale - A somber but energetic, **ghost-obsessed bartender**. She wears an old bomber jacket with paranormal themed patches, and has silver and purple hair. She **moved here after the accident**, believing that Phantom Peak is 'the most active spiritual site up north'.

She l**ost her husband to cancer** many years ago, and her eyes are weary with loneliness and grief. **Secret:** Nessa seeks the Phantom's essence to brew a drink like no other - a drink which she believes will allow the drinkers to **see their deceased loved ones again**.

Points of Interest:

Bar Counter: Several bottles line the bar, and shot and beer glasses cover the surface. Some of the bottles contain glowing spirits - if questioned, Nessa tells them that they are **'experimental brews'**.

Ledger Book: Lists tabs and names - some of which match miners who died years ago.

Photograph on the Wall: A framed photo of Elias Brandt with a younger Martha Kellis and Felix Orner, smiling in front of the mine entrance. A faint crack runs through Felix's face in the glass.

Storage Room: Locked. Contains backup generator fuel and a few first aid supplies.

Distillation Rig: In a side room is a bizarre contraption of copper tubing, candles, and crystal glassware. It hums faintly. Nessa claims it can create any cocktail as long as the 'correct ingredients' are provided.

Basement Access: A hatch in the floor leads down to the "Cellar of Spirits" - rows of empty bottles labeled with dates, names, and sometimes the cause of death.

Abandoned Radio Tower

A rickety metal structure once used to broadcast Phantom Peak Radio. It is disused and the access ladder is broken halfway up.

NPCS:

Radio Broadcaster (Deceased)

Points of Interest:

Control Room: A control room at the top of the metal structure with a broadcast console. A **dead man** lies slumped in the chair.

Recording: A recorder with a distorted final transmission: "*It's real. It's here with me. Don't come up the mountain.*"

Broadcast Console: Can be used to radio for help. "*We're sending a rescue team in the morning.*" (...they never arrive.)

Encounters:

The Phantom may manifest the voice of a Guilt Form over the radio, directing the players **to the mine**.

The tower can also be climbed to get a vantage point.

Hazards:

Structural instability — a failed climb or a fight can collapse part of the platform.

Abandoned Chapel

NPCS:

Vicar - A Phantom taking the form of a vicar with a slashed wound across his neck.

Points of Interest:

Church Bell: A large, disused bell. Could be rung to weaken the Phantom.

Graveyard: One grave freshly disturbed.

Ledger of Burials: Last few pages scribbled with "they always come back."

Goblet of Blood: A chalice filled with blood on the altar. It tastes coppery and metallic.

The Supply Shed

There is a small shed just to the side of the reception with a small generator inside it, tools and **hunting rifles**.

NPCS:

None

Points of Interest:

Small Generator: The generator has been sabotaged and won't turn on.

Hunting Rifles: 1–2 usable; others jammed or rusted. Ammo limited. One gun is missing from the rack.

Workbench: Tools, ropes, and an open locker with bloody fingerprints**.**

Optional Encounter: A half-starved hunting dog, seemingly abandoned. If treated with kindness, it will follow the group briefly, barking at potential threats.

Lover's Lookout

A small area on the edge of the park known as Lover's Lookout for being a place where young people would have their first kiss in Phantom Peak's prime.

NPCS:

Ghostly figures of young lovers - they fell over the railing to their deaths.

Points of Interest:

Telescope: Cracked lens but usable. Players can spot a moving shape on the mine path if successful on a Perception check.

Rusted Railing: A railing which is rusted and bent in many places. It seems as though it could give way at any point. May give way under stress, potentially lethal fall or leads to a hidden ledge below (small loot cache or body). Fresh footprints that lead over the cliff and stop.

Carved Heart: "M+L Forever" — letters match **Max Winterfern** with his fiancee **Laura**.

The Infirmary

One of the older cabins has been converted into a small infirmary and morgue.

NPCS:

Dr. Martha Kellis - Nervous and skeptical. Knows about the Phantom. Secret: Believes she was the only survivor of the mining accident; believes it was her fault.

Points of Interest:

Morgue: Ledger of dead patients, several labelled 'stress-induced'. A frozen corpse is preserved by the cold, and looks to have been dead for a while.

Medical Bench: Jars labeled "experimental." One contains a Phantom tissue sample.

Phonograph: Plays recordings of Martha interviewing patients about "the voices." One voice matches Elias's.

Mine Entrance

Blinding snow and roaring wind. The entrance to the mines is situated on the side of a mountain.

NPCS:

None

Points of Interest:

Shrines: Several old shrines with wilted flowers are set up around the mine entrance, in memory of the miners who died in the accident.

Boarded Entrance: Scratched warnings ("TURN BACK," "IT WAKES"). Breaking boards release a gust of freezing air and a low moan.

Elevator: Just inside is a rickety elevator with a sliding door. Rusted cage. Inside, someone carved "LAST DESCENT" in the metal. The floor is stained with old blood. There is a gaping hole in the elevator door in the shape of claws. As the elevator descends, it is jerky and groans, the small light flickering.

Optional Encounter: As players descend, they hear a distorted radio message - the Phantom luring them deeper.

The Mines

The tunnels into the mines are treacherous and poorly maintained.

NPCS:

None

Points of Interest:

Abandoned Gear: Helmets, lanterns, and abandoned pickaxes. Rusted lockers with abandoned personal effects and old mining tools.

Mine Carts and Dynamite: Mining carts or dynamite that can be rigged to collapse tunnels to block the Phantom temporarily.

Warnings: Strange carvings on walls hinting at the Phantom's nature. Some might be protective sigils or warnings to avoid certain paths.

Collapsed Tunnel: Digging through reveals either loot or a skeletal hand clutching a lantern.

Optional Encounter: Echoing footsteps mimic the party's pace - sometimes *one step too many*.

Hazards:

Flooded tunnels, falling rocks, or unstable scaffolds.

The Phantom's Lair

The Phantom's Lair lies in a large opening where many mining tunnels converge.

NPCS:

The Phantom (True Form)

Points of Interest:

Old Mining Altar: A ritual area where miners tried to appease "the thing below."

Phantom Peak Map

